

Blue Team Defense & Incident Response Report

Project: HawkEye Lab

Objective:

To monitor network traffic, detect unauthorized access attempts, and mitigate the brute-force attack on the system.

Detection & Analysis:

1. **Continuous Monitoring:** Analyzed system firewall logs and intrusion detection system (IDS) alerts.
2. **Incident Detection:** Detected an abnormal spike in network traffic targeting Port 22 (SSH). Log analysis revealed multiple failed login attempts originating from a single external IP address within a short timeframe, confirming an active brute-force dictionary attack.
3. **Impact Assessment:** Identified that the attacker eventually succeeded in bypassing the authentication and gaining root access.

Containment & Mitigation:

1. **Immediate Response:** Instantly blocked the attacker's IP address at the firewall level to terminate the active session.
2. **Security Hardening:** Disabled direct root login via SSH in the configuration file (sshd_config) and restarted the service to prevent further escalation.

Conclusion:

The brute-force attack was successfully detected using log analysis, and immediate incident response protocols were executed to contain the breach and secure the network.

[Evidence / Incident Detection Logs]

```
Sep 11 10:14:22 HawkEye-Server sshd: Failed password for root from 10.0.2.15
port 44521 ssh2
Sep 11 10:14:24 HawkEye-Server sshd: Failed password for root from 10.0.2.15
port 44525 ssh2
Sep 11 10:14:26 HawkEye-Server sshd: Accepted password for root from 10.0.2.15
port 44528 ssh2
[ALERT] Multiple failed login attempts detected. IP 10.0.2.15 blocked by
iptables.
```